militia and from Yulbar Khan's White Russian and Hui troops who served the KMT's Republic of China. Batur had pledged his allegiance to the KMT and was killed in 1951.

The British Consul in Kashgar, Eric Shipton left in October 1948 after handing over charge to his deputy Allen Mersh. Mersh was of Anglo-Indian descent and had opted for Pakistani citizenship. He remained in charge till 1949, when he abandoned the post. The consulate was back in Indian control after Capt. R. D. Sathe took charge. In early 1950, the British consul in Urumchi was expelled for his links with Yulbar Khan and he took refuge in the Indian consulate in Kashgar. Shortly thereafter, Capt. Sathe also left Kashgar, never to return.

In his dispatches to the US State Department in December 1951, the new American Ambassador to India, Chester Bowles wrote that in the coming years, the danger from China to Jammu and Kashmir was likely to be much greater. In fact, Bowles found Nehru's political views replete with contradictions on communism and he seemed irritatingly stubborn on Kashmir.[19] Things changed dramatically when on 17 January 1952, Soviet Ambassador Jacob Malik made a speech in the Security Council accusing America and Britain of brazen, imperial intervention in Kashmir. The American delegation to the UN interpreted this speech as a definition of the Soviet stand on a number of issues. The Soviets could simultaneously favour the communists in the 1952 first general elections in India and harm Pakistan and India but also Egypt. The British added that it also reflected the Soviet desire to support an independent Kashmir under the leftist Abdullah. Abdullah's remarks to Selwyn Lloyd, the British Minister for Foreign Affairs, about his vision of independence for Jammu and Kashmir and his indifference towards the Soviet threat, further confirmed that his ideas were completely contrary to those of Whitehall.[20]

By the end of January 1952, it was clear that Malik's attempt to create greater uncertainty over Soviet intentions in Kashmir only benefitted Abdullah and the communists. The British foreign office concluded that while the Soviets were certainly not hoping to win Pakistan's sympathy, they also seemed to have overlooked that Nehru was against the